

Time Management Guide

For students and working professionals

Reading time: 5 minutes

Time saved in future: infinite

Outline

1. Procrastination
2. Eisenhower Matrix
3. Time blocking
4. How your phone destroys you
5. Work efficient effective

Procrastination

Why we delay and how to overcome it

Understanding procrastination

Procrastination is that annoying habit of putting off important tasks, only to feel stressed and rushed later. We've all been there: knowing we should be studying but ending up scrolling through social media instead.

Procrastination often comes from fear—fear of failure, fear of discomfort, or sometimes just feeling overwhelmed by the sheer size of a task. Our brains are wired to avoid things that feel hard or uncomfortable, so we look for ways to distract ourselves.

Why it happens

Fear of failure

We might avoid starting because we're worried we won't do it well.

Perfectionism

Waiting until we feel "ready" or everything is perfect can hold us back.

Overwhelm

Sometimes a task seems so big that it's hard to know where to start.

Instant gratification

Our brains are attracted to things that feel good in the short term, like checking social media, rather than things that have long-term benefits, like studying.

How to handle procrastination

1. Break tasks into smaller steps

When something feels overwhelming, break it down into bite-sized steps. For example, instead of "study for exam," make a plan to "review chapter 1".

2. The 5-minute rule

Commit to doing something for just 5 minutes. Usually, you'll end up continuing once you've started.

3. Set realistic goals

Be clear about what you want to achieve in each session. Don't aim too high; small wins build confidence.

4. Reward yourself

After completing a task, treat yourself with something small. It could be a 10-minute break or a snack.

The Eisenhower Matrix

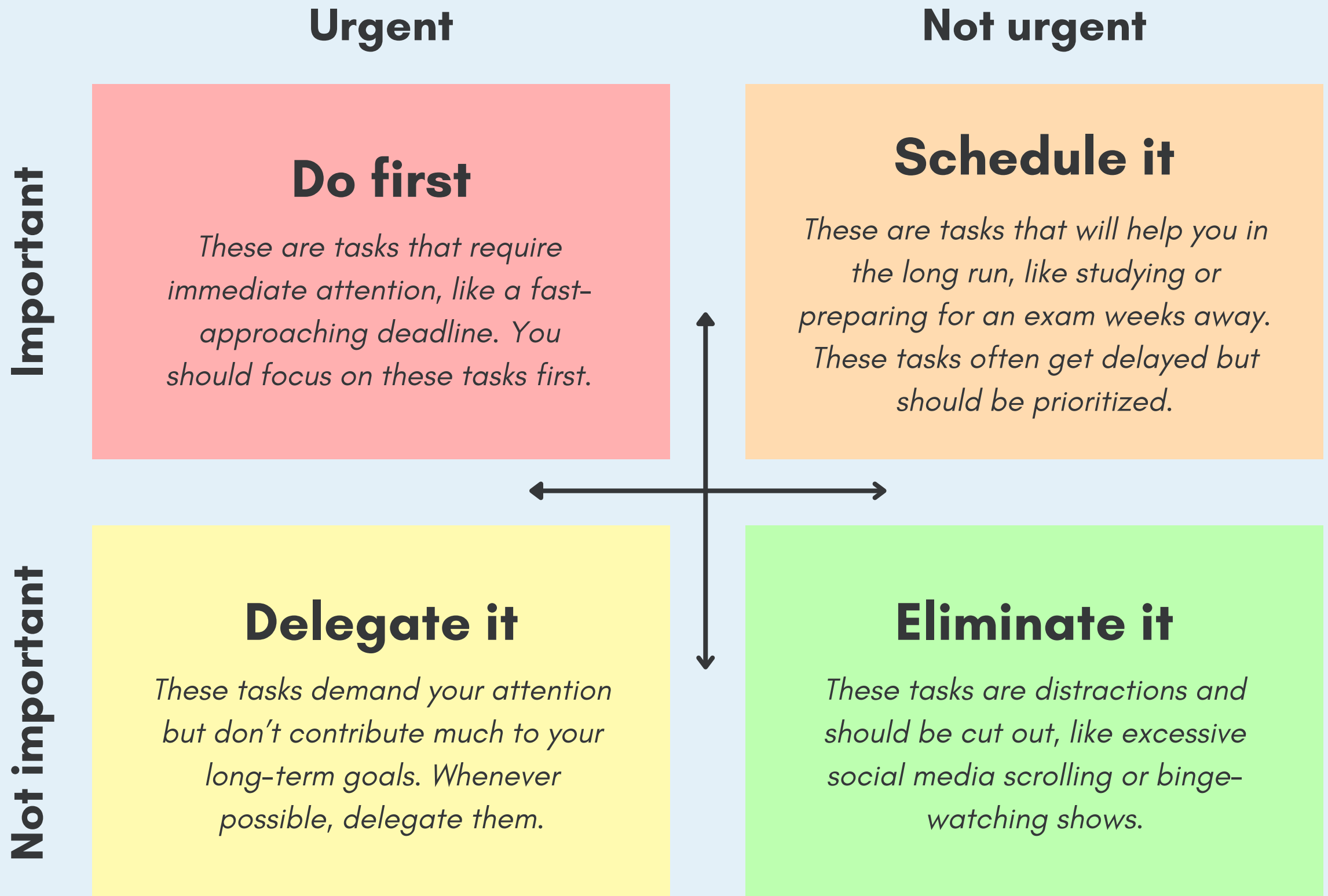
Prioritizing what matters

The Eisenhower Matrix is a powerful tool for deciding what needs your attention. It separates your tasks into four categories based on urgency and importance.

This system helps you avoid spending time on things that feel urgent but aren't truly important.

How to use it

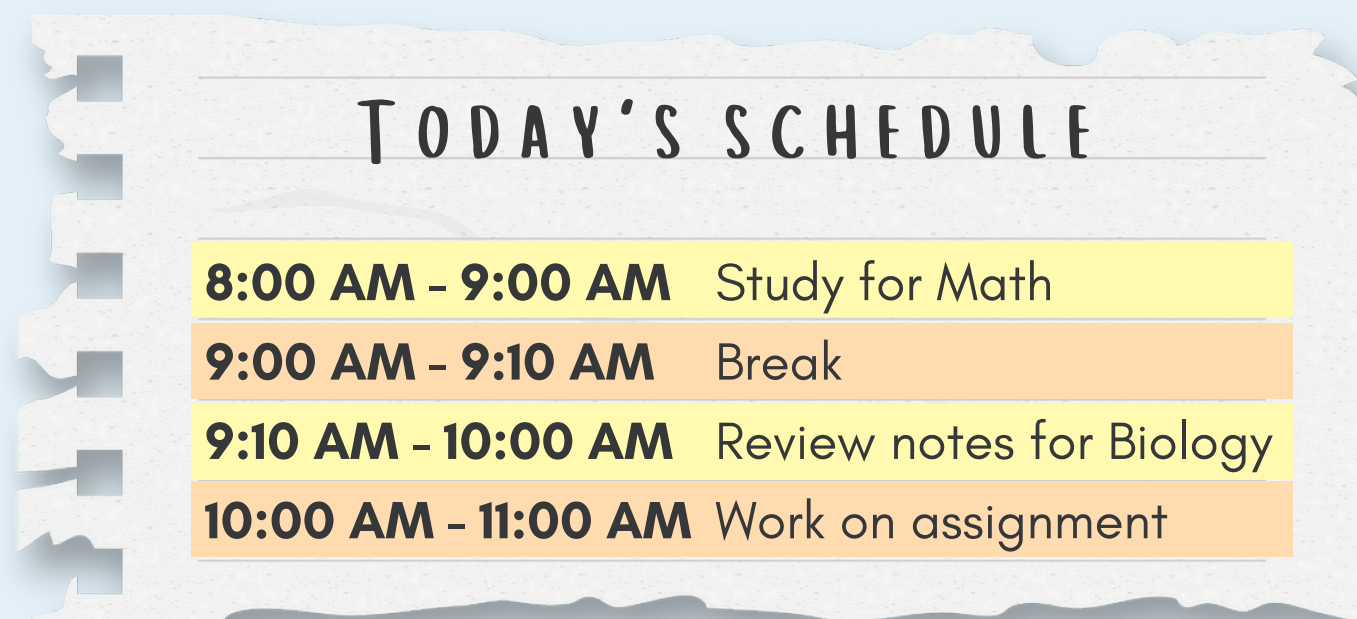
- At the start of the week, list your tasks, then sort them into the four categories.
- Focus on doing the urgent and important tasks first, but make sure to schedule time for the important but not urgent ones.
- Delegate or drop tasks that don't help you meet your goals.



Time Blocking

Structuring your day

Time blocking is a method where you assign specific tasks to blocks of time throughout your day. This strategy helps ensure you're dedicating enough time to the things that matter while keeping distractions at bay.



This method helps you create a daily structure, reduces the chance of distractions, and gives you a sense of control over your time.

How it works

1. Choose your tasks

Start by listing the tasks you need to accomplish. Include everything from studying and assignments to personal time and breaks.

2. Create blocks of time

Allocate specific times for each task. For example, from 10 AM to 11 AM, you could block out time to read a chapter for class.

3. Stick to the schedule

The key to time blocking is discipline. Stick to your blocks and avoid doing other things during that time.

4. Include breaks

Don't forget to block time for breaks. A 5-10 minute break every hour can help you recharge and stay productive.

Phones and procrastination

How your phone is wasting your time

Our phones are productivity killers. Notifications, messages, and endless scrolling eat away at valuable time, even though we only mean to take “quick” breaks.

Why phones distract us

Instant gratification

We're wired to seek quick rewards. Notifications and social media give us that dopamine hit.

Constant availability

With our phones, we feel the need to respond to every message or notification instantly, even when it's not urgent.

Multitasking myth

We think we can check our phone and work at the same time, but studies show this actually slows us down.

How to take back control

1. Turn off notifications

Limit the apps that can send you notifications, especially during study time.

2. Use focus modes or Do Not Disturb

Both iPhone and Android have features that block non-essential notifications when you're working.

3. Set phone-free time blocks

During study sessions, keep your phone out of reach or turn it off.

4. Limit social media time

Set daily limits for social media apps to prevent endless scrolling.

Time management techniques

Working more efficiently and effectively

Pomodoro Technique

One method to work more efficiently is the Pomodoro Technique. This involves working in focused bursts, usually 25 minutes, followed by a 5-minute break. After four Pomodoros, take a longer break (15-30 minutes). This keeps you focused while also giving your brain time to rest.

Active recall

Rather than passively rereading notes, test yourself on the material. This engages your brain more deeply and helps you remember information better.

Spaced repetition

Instead of cramming all your studying into one session, spread it out over time. Review material at increasing intervals to improve long-term retention.

Batching tasks

Batching involves grouping similar tasks together. For example, if you need to reply to emails, set aside a specific time to reply to all of them at once instead of checking throughout the day.

Focus on one thing at a time

Multitasking sounds productive, but it actually reduces efficiency. Concentrate fully on one task at a time, finish it, and then move on to the next.

Conclusion

Putting it all together



Mastering time management is a skill that requires practice. By understanding procrastination, using the Eisenhower Matrix to prioritize, structuring your day with time blocking, reducing phone distractions, and adopting efficient work methods, you'll be well on your way to making the most of your time as a student.

If you want to get video and course material about these topics, bi-weekly workshops live with me and need more support, join my

free StudyCoach School



Templates

	Urgent	Not urgent
Important	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Not important	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Time	Task